

Associative learning of social interaction alters attention to human faces

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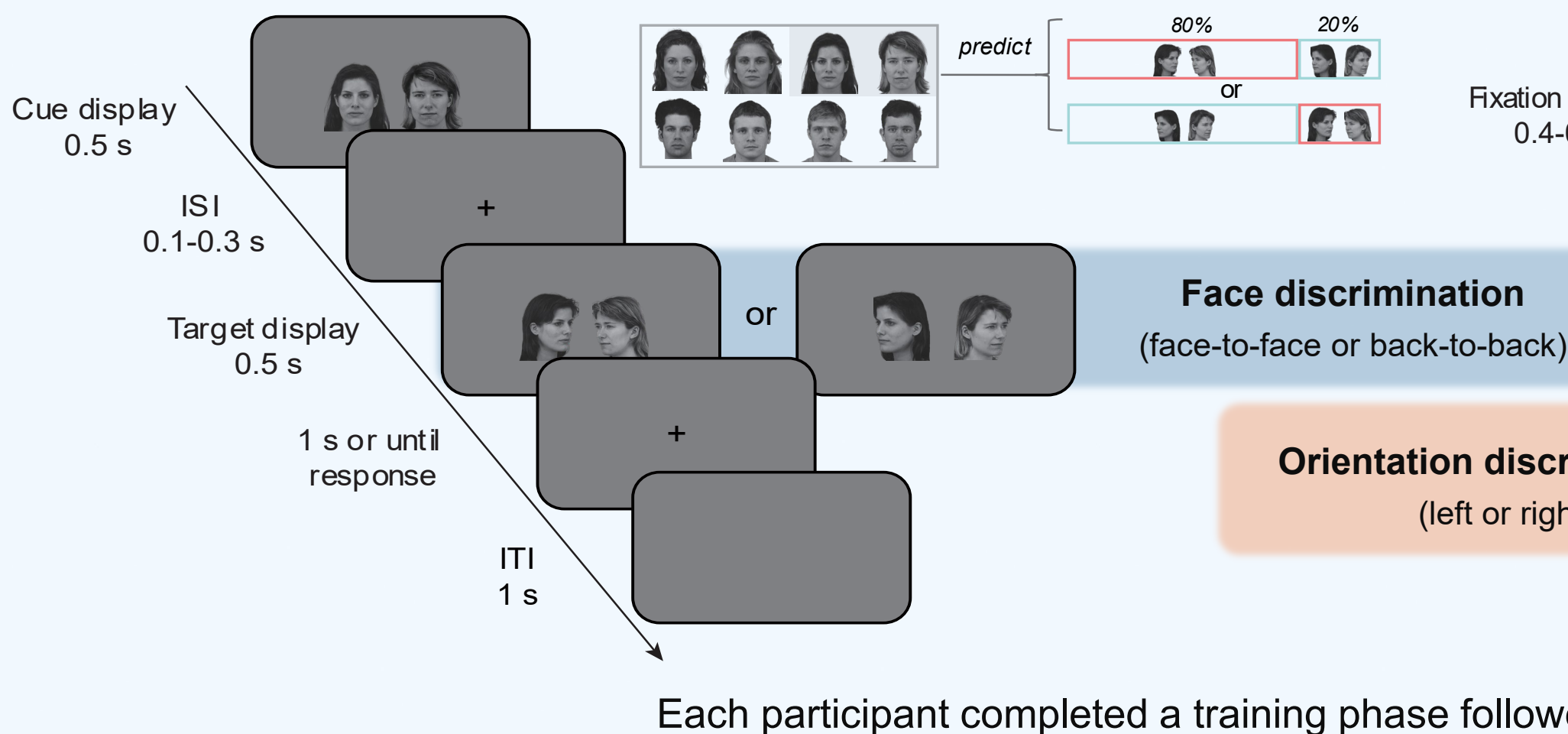
Introduction

- Beyond current goals and physical salience, selection history biases visual attention. But previous evidence has focused primarily on non-social regularities (reward and spatial probabilities).
- Social interactions (face-to-face dyads) receive prioritized visual processing over non-interacting configurations (back-to-back dyads).

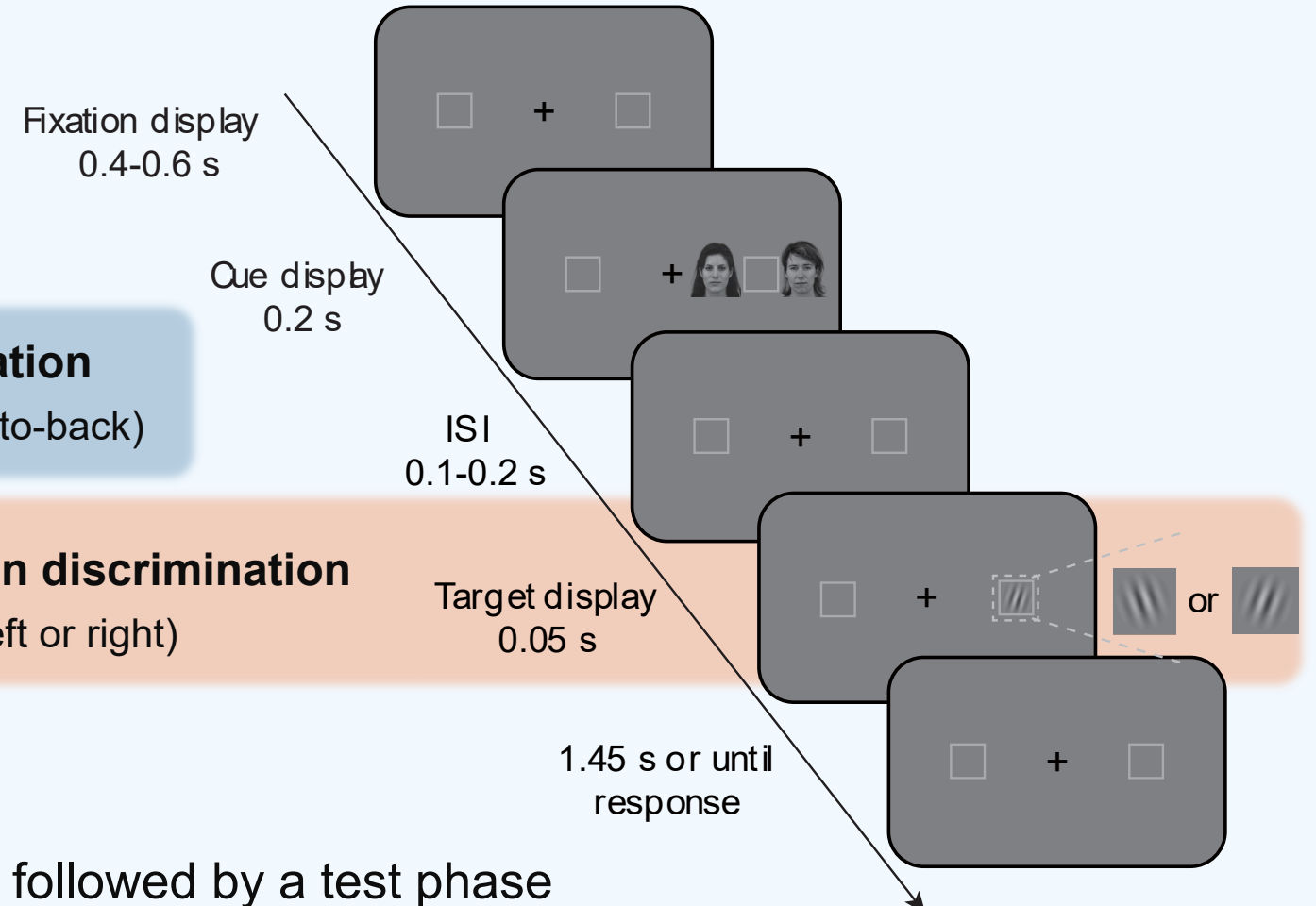
Question: Can social interaction history alter attentional priority for human faces?

Methods

Training: Associative learning task



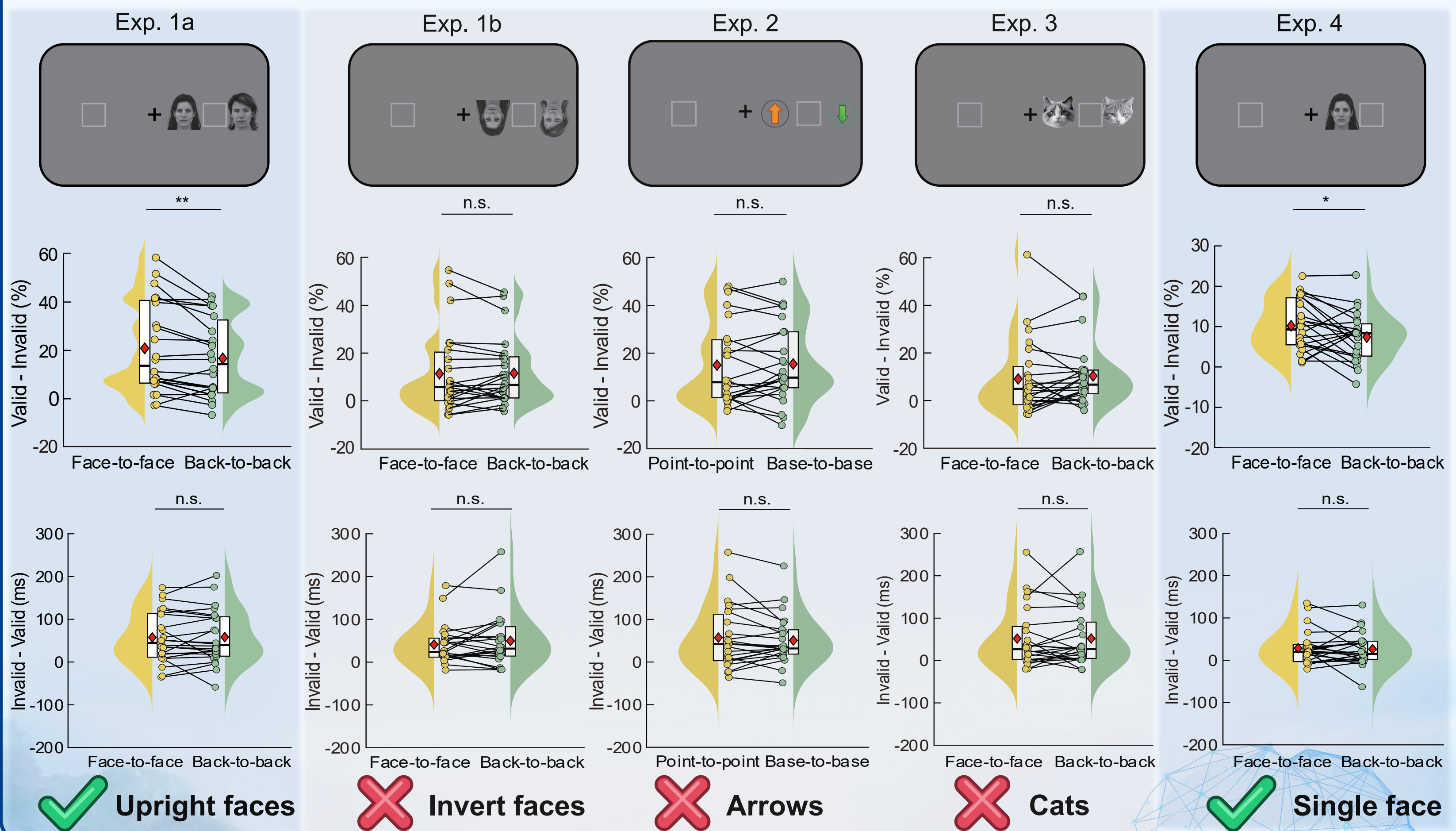
Test: Spatial cuing task



Each participant completed a training phase followed by a test phase

Results

Cuing effect: the difference between valid and invalid cue



Conclusion

- Faces previously seen interacting capture attention more than non-interacting ones.
- Attentional bias disappears with inverted faces and nonsocial directional stimuli.
- Social interaction history shapes subsequent attentional selection.